

18. 1250 – XV, eap ($2 = 1$, $1/2 = 10$, $1 = 77$ [3 subs], odd = 3) = 91; [$\mathbf{f}^{35} \pm 2$]
19. 1247 – XV, eap ($2 = 1$, $1/2 = 10$, $1 = 81$ [3 subs], odd = 3) = 95; [$\mathbf{f}^{35} \pm 2$]
20. 1876 – XV, apr ($2 = 1$, $1/2 = 11$, $1 = 83$ [3 subs], odd = 3) = 98; [$\mathbf{f}^{35} \pm 2$]
21. 1249 – 1324, ap ($2 = 1$, $1/2 = 10$, $1 = 84$ [3 subs], odd = 2) = 97; [$\mathbf{f}^{35} \pm 1$]
22. 1248 – XIV, eap ($2 = 1$, $1/2 = 11$, $1 = 84$ [3 subs], sing = 1, odd = 1) = 98; [$\mathbf{f}^{35} \pm 1$]
23. 2501 – XVI, ap ($2 = 1$, $1/2 = 11$, $1 = 83$ [5 subs], odd = 1) = 96; [$\mathbf{f}^{35} \pm 4$]
24. 2085 – 1308, ap ($2 = 0$, $1/2 = 11$, $1 = 84$ [3 subs], sing = 1, odd = 2) = 98;
25. 1244 – XI, ap ($2 = 0$, $1/2 = 10$, $1 = 85$ [3 subs], odd = 2) = 97;
26. 2799 – XIV, ap ($2 = 0$, $1/2 = 3$, $1 = 28$ [2 subs], sing = 1, odd = 1) = 33.¹

Absolutely no two MSS are identical; even the six $\mathbf{f}^{35}$ MSS all differ by at least one variant. The rest of the Byzantine MSS are all distinct, some really so,² yet all clearly fall within the Byzantine tradition.³ These 26 MSS represent as many exemplars; there was no ‘inbreeding’, no stuffing the ballot box; each copyist tried to reproduce what was in front of him, regardless of the type of text. Since the MSS were still there in 1800, they were not made to fill an order from elsewhere. Given its isolation, some

¹ The last three MSS have very different profiles.

² Notice that no MS scores a perfect 87 for LESART 1, and only four score a perfect 11 for LESART 1/2.

³ Remember that we are only looking at 98 variant sets—if we had complete collations for the seven books it is almost certain that no two MSS would be identical (from all sources); perhaps for a single book, the smaller the better, a few might be found. [I wrote the above in 2004, when I was just beginning to really pay attention to $\mathbf{f}^{35}$ —in fact, within that family, considering only the MSS that I myself have collated, we can say the following: I have in my possession copies of thirty identical MSS for both 2 and 3 John (not identical lists), twenty-nine for Philemon, twenty-two for Jude, fifteen for 2 Thessalonians, nine for Titus, six each for Galatians, Colossians and 1 Thessalonians, five each for Philippians and 2 Peter, four each for Ephesians, James and 1 John, three each for 2 Timothy and 1 Peter, and two each for Romans and 1 Timothy. It is not the same selection of MSS in each case, and they come from all over.] Apart from $\mathbf{f}^{35}$ I would still be surprised to find identical copies of any book with over 3 chapters.